



Epic clash: Jannik Sinner and Alexander Zverev pushed each other to the limit in a Wimbledon final that showcased the speed, power and supreme fitness of modern tennis. AFP

becomes a free hit. That often changes the course of the game, as was seen in the second game, where India were in a good position till the no-balls came along. **The momentum shifted in just one over, and a game that could have been won was lost.**

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There's been a lot of talk about how playing on flat batting pitches has spoiled the Indian batters. Even on the so-called flat pitches in

the IPL, most of the Indian batters struggled against the short ball. That is more a technical failing. With the weight on the front foot and the back foot locked, there is simply no transfer of weight to deal with a ball climbing towards the face. **That said, the short boundaries are also to blame, as many of the sixes hit just about clear the boundary rope and so could be catches elsewhere.** This has to be looked at urgently if India is to reclaim the ODI title on the faster, bouncier pitches in South Africa.

Every ground in India can have longer boundaries, but is there the will for that? That is the question. We shall soon see.



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